



THE CONSTITUTION *OF THE* BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT (BYM)

AN INSTRUMENT ESTABLISHING THE
BYM YOUTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY
(EXECUTIVE COUNCIL)
AND THE
BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT
(LEGISLATIVE CHAMBER)

AS THE GOVERNANCE INSTRUMENTS OF THE BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT

Sefwi Bekwai · Western North Region · Republic of Ghana

FIRST EDITION · 2026

Reference: BYM-CONST-2026/I



CERTIFICATE OF ENACTMENT

This Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement, having been drafted by the founding leadership of the Movement, deliberated upon, and adopted at the Founding Convention held at Sefwi Bekwai in the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipality, Western North Region of the Republic of Ghana, is hereby certified as the supreme governance instrument of the Bekwai Youth Movement and shall come into force on the date of its formal ratification.

This Constitution is enacted in pursuance of the right of citizens of the Republic of Ghana to associate freely under Article 21(1)(e) of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, and consistent with the laws of the Republic regulating community-based and not-for-profit organisations, and in furtherance of the Sustainable Development Goals (2030 Agenda) of the United Nations.

ENACTED at Sefwi Bekwai on this _____ day of _____, 2026.

PRESIDENT, BYM Youth General Assembly

(Founding President)

**SECRETARY-GENERAL, Bekwai Youth
Movement**

(Founding Secretary-General)

PATRON, Traditional Advisory Council

*(Paramount Chief or Designated
Representative)*

WITNESS, Independent Counsel

(Legal Adviser to the Movement)

Official Seal of the Bekwai Youth Movement: _____



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PREAMBLE

WE, the founding members of the Bekwai Youth Movement, comprising the youth and concerned citizens of Sefwi Bekwai and its surrounding communities in the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipality of the Western North Region of the Republic of Ghana —

ACKNOWLEDGING the rich heritage of the Sefwi people, the wisdom of our chiefs and elders, and the enduring traditions of the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Area;

RECOGNISING the immense untapped potential of young persons within our communities, and the urgent necessity of structured, transparent and sustained civic engagement;

AFFIRMING our commitment to the supremacy of the laws of the Republic of Ghana, particularly the 1992 Constitution and the freedom of association guaranteed thereby;

RESOLVED to establish a permanent, non-partisan, non-political and not-for-profit movement dedicated to the development of our community for not less than forty (40) years;

COMMITTED to the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Sustainable Development Goals adopted by the international community in the year 2015;

DETERMINED to ensure that every community within our jurisdiction enjoys the right to representation, the dignity of participation, and the benefits of structured development;

DO HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT, ORDAIN, AND GIVE TO OURSELVES this Constitution as the supreme governance instrument of the Bekwai Youth Movement.

PROCLAMATION OF FOUNDING

May this Constitution stand as a covenant between generations — between those who built before us, those who serve today, and those who shall inherit Sefwi Bekwai tomorrow. May it be honoured in spirit and obeyed in letter, and may the Bekwai Youth Movement, under the protection of God and the wisdom of our forebears, faithfully discharge the duties hereby committed to its trust.



PART I – PRELIMINARY

ARTICLE 1 – CITATION, COMMENCEMENT AND APPLICATION

1.1 Citation

- (1) This instrument may be cited as the Constitution of the Bekwai Youth Movement, 2026 (hereinafter referred to as "this Constitution").
- (2) This Constitution shall, in all official records, be referenced as BYM-CONST-2026/I and any subsequent amendment shall be designated by reference to its year and serial number.

1.2 Commencement

- (1) This Constitution shall come into operation on the date of its formal adoption by the Founding Convention of the Bekwai Youth Movement, being the date of execution appearing on the Certificate of Enactment, and shall continue in force until amended, replaced, or repealed in accordance with its own provisions.
- (2) Until the Founding Convention is duly convened, no provision of this Constitution shall create binding obligation save for those provisions necessary for the proper preparation and holding of the said Convention.

1.3 Application and Binding Force

- (1) This Constitution shall apply to and bind, without distinction or exception:
 - (a) every Member of the Bekwai Youth Movement, of whatever category;
 - (b) every Officer, Cabinet Secretary, Member of Parliament, Community Intelligence Officer, Volunteer, and Representative of the Movement;
 - (c) every Unit, Volunteer Action Team, and constituted body operating under the auspices of the Movement;
 - (d) every act, decision, resolution, or undertaking made in the name of the Movement; and
 - (e) every property, fund, account, and asset of the Movement, whether real or personal, tangible or intangible.
- (2) All members, officers, and constituted bodies of the Movement shall, upon assumption of office or enrolment, be deemed to have accepted, in full, the terms of this Constitution.

1.4 Construction



- (1) This Constitution shall be construed in a manner consistent with the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, the Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992) where applicable, and all other enactments of the Republic having force of law.
- (2) Where any provision of this Constitution is found to be in conflict with the laws of the Republic of Ghana, the said laws shall prevail, and the conflicting provision shall be read down or severed to the extent of the inconsistency.
- (3) Headings and side-notes are inserted for ease of reference only and shall not affect the construction of any Article.



ARTICLE 2 — DEFINITIONS AND INTERPRETATION

2.1 General Definitions

In this Constitution, unless the context otherwise requires:

"Movement" means the Bekwai Youth Movement established under Article 5 of this Constitution, including its constituent organs, Units, and Action Teams;

"BYM" means the Bekwai Youth Movement, being the abbreviated style by which the Movement may be cited;

"Constitution" means this present instrument, including all Schedules forming part hereof, and any duly enacted amendments thereto;

"Assembly" means the BYM Youth General Assembly, being the executive body established under Article 13;

"Cabinet" means the Cabinet of the BYM Youth General Assembly, comprising the President, the Vice Presidents, and all Secretaries of State, as constituted under Article 15;

"President" means the President of the BYM Youth General Assembly, being the principal executive officer of the Movement, holding office under Article 15.1;

"Parliament" means the Bekwai Youth Parliament, being the legislative chamber established under Article 18;

"Speaker" means the Speaker of the Bekwai Youth Parliament, being the presiding officer of Parliament under Article 19.3;

"Member" means any person duly admitted into membership of the Movement under Article 9, of any category;

"Officer" means any person holding any office created under, or pursuant to, this Constitution, including without limitation members of the Cabinet, the Speaker and Officers of Parliament, the Director of Community Intelligence, and Officers of the Traditional Advisory Council;

"Community" means any one of the thirty-two (32) communities listed in Schedule II of this Constitution, comprising Sefwi Bekwai town and the thirty-one (31) surrounding sub-communities falling within the geographical jurisdiction of the Movement;

"Sub-Chief" means the recognised traditional chief, family head, or designated traditional authority of a Community;

"Paramount Chief" means the Paramount Chief of the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Area, being the apex traditional authority of the geographical area within which the Movement operates;



"TAC" means the Traditional Advisory Council, established under Article 22 as the advisory body comprising traditional authorities;

"CIN" means the Community Intelligence Network, being the data-collection and reporting body established under Article 25.3;

"CIN Officer" means an officer of the Community Intelligence Network, appointed in accordance with Article 25.3 to represent and report from a designated Community;

"Founding Leadership" means the persons named in the Founding Register of the Movement as the founding members thereof, being those who initiated and convened the Founding Convention;

"Founding Convention" means the inaugural convention of the Movement at which this Constitution was deliberated upon and adopted;

"Sitting" means any duly convened meeting of the Cabinet, of Parliament, of any Unit, or of any constituted body of the Movement;

"Quorum" means the minimum number of members or officers required to be present for the lawful transaction of business at a Sitting, as specified in this Constitution;

"Resolution" means a formal decision adopted by the Cabinet, by Parliament, or by any constituted body of the Movement, by a majority of those present and voting, save where this Constitution requires a special majority;

"Schedule" means any one of the Schedules forming part of this Constitution, having the same legal force as the Articles to which it relates;

"Republic" means the Republic of Ghana;

"SDGs" means the Sustainable Development Goals adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations in the year 2015 as part of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development;

"Year" means in relation to the Movement's financial and operational records, the calendar year commencing on 1 January and ending on 31 December, save where the Cabinet shall otherwise determine and publish in advance;

"Resident" means in respect of any person seeking representation of a Community, a person whose primary place of residence is the said Community, being the place where such person ordinarily lives, sleeps, and is known to community members and the Sub-Chief, with the residency requirements set out in Article 11.4;

"Person" means save where the context requires otherwise, any natural person and, where applicable, any body corporate or unincorporated association recognised under the laws of the Republic;

"Writing" means communication in printed or electronic form capable of being reduced to permanent record;



"Annual General Assembly" means the annual plenary gathering of the Movement, held under Article 16.5;

"Pre-Launch" means the formal pre-launch ceremony of the Movement, held on the 24th day of December 2026;

"Official Launch" means the formal Official Launch of the Movement, held on the 12th day of January 2027.

2.2 Rules of Interpretation

- (1)** Words importing the masculine gender shall include the feminine and the neuter, and words importing the singular shall include the plural and vice versa.
- (2)** References to any law, statute, or regulation are references to that law as amended, re-enacted, or replaced from time to time.
- (3)** Where a power is conferred or a duty imposed by this Constitution, the said power may be exercised and the said duty performed from time to time as occasion requires.
- (4)** References to days mean calendar days unless expressly stated otherwise; and where the time prescribed for the doing of any act expires on a public holiday or weekend, the act shall be deemed timely if performed on the next working day.
- (5)** References to a number of months shall mean calendar months and not lunar months.



ARTICLE 3 – SUPREMACY OF THE CONSTITUTION

3.1 Supremacy

- (1) This Constitution is, and shall be, the supreme governance instrument of the Bekwai Youth Movement; and any act, resolution, by-law, regulation, or undertaking made by any organ, officer, or member of the Movement which is inconsistent with any provision of this Constitution shall, to the extent of the inconsistency, be void.
- (2) No officer, member, body, or organ of the Movement shall have authority to do any act, take any decision, or assume any obligation contrary to this Constitution.

3.2 Hierarchy of Instruments

- (1) The hierarchy of governance instruments within the Movement shall be as follows:
 - (a) this Constitution, including its Schedules;
 - (b) any Standing Orders of the Cabinet duly adopted under Article 16;
 - (c) any Standing Orders of Parliament duly adopted under Article 20;
 - (d) any By-Laws or Regulations adopted by the Cabinet for the conduct of Units, Volunteer Action Teams, or other operational matters;
 - (e) policies, guidelines, manuals, and operational documents.
- (2) An instrument lower in the hierarchy shall, in case of conflict, give way to one higher in the hierarchy.

3.3 Saving of Republic Laws

Notwithstanding any provision of this Constitution, all officers and members of the Movement remain subject to the laws of the Republic of Ghana, and nothing in this Constitution shall be construed as exempting any person from the application of those laws.



ARTICLE 4 — VISION, MISSION AND CORE VALUES

4.1 Vision

The vision of the Movement is the establishment, over not less than forty (40) years, of a model youth-led community development institution which transforms Sefwi Bekwai and its surrounding communities into a national exemplar of structured civic governance, economic dignity, educational excellence, and sustainable development.

4.2 Mission

The mission of the Movement is to harness, organise, and direct the potential of all young persons in Sefwi Bekwai and its thirty-one (31) surrounding sub-communities through structured executive governance, legislative deliberation, community intelligence, volunteer action, and partnership with traditional authorities — in alignment with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals and the laws of the Republic of Ghana.

4.3 Core Values

The Movement shall, at all times, be guided by the following core values:

- (1) Integrity — adherence to truthfulness, honesty, and transparent conduct in all matters.
- (2) Service — placing the interests of the community above personal advantage.
- (3) Inclusion — ensuring that no Community, gender, faith, or social group is excluded from representation.
- (4) Non-Partisanship — strict abstention from political party affiliation in any official capacity.
- (5) Accountability — open record-keeping, transparent reporting, and responsiveness to the community served.
- (6) Excellence — the pursuit of the highest standards in every undertaking of the Movement.
- (7) Respect for Tradition — honouring the authority of Chiefs and the wisdom of elders, and integrating traditional governance into modern civic action.



PART II — ESTABLISHMENT, NAME AND LEGAL STATUS

ARTICLE 5 — ESTABLISHMENT OF THE BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT

5.1 Establishment

- (1) There is hereby established, in pursuance of the right of citizens of the Republic of Ghana to associate freely under Article 21(1)(e) of the 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, an unincorporated community-based association to be known as the BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT.
- (2) The Movement may, at the discretion of the Cabinet and with the approval of two-thirds of the membership at a duly convened General Assembly, be incorporated under the laws of the Republic in any form considered appropriate, including registration under the Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992) as a company limited by guarantee.

5.2 Headquarters and Operating Base

- (1) The headquarters and principal operating base of the Movement shall be at Sefwi Bekwai in the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipality of the Western North Region of the Republic of Ghana.
- (2) The Cabinet may, by resolution, establish satellite offices or operational hubs in any of the Communities listed in Schedule II of this Constitution.

5.3 Founding Date

The Movement is hereby founded in the year of Our Lord Two Thousand and Twenty-Six (2026), with the Pre-Launch Ceremony to be held on the 24th day of December, 2026, and the Official Launch on the 12th day of January, 2027.

5.4 Duration

- (1) The Movement is established for a perpetual existence; provided, however, that the founding leadership commits to a minimum operational horizon of forty (40) years from the date of the Official Launch.
- (2) Dissolution of the Movement shall only be effected in accordance with the provisions of Article 33.



ARTICLE 6 — LEGAL STATUS, CAPACITY AND LIABILITIES

6.1 Legal Status

- (1) The Movement, until and unless formally incorporated, shall operate as an unincorporated community-based association governed by this Constitution and the general laws of the Republic of Ghana relating to such associations.
- (2) Notwithstanding sub-clause (1), the Cabinet may at any time take steps to confer upon the Movement a separate legal personality through registration under any law of the Republic, including:
 - (a) registration as a Company Limited by Guarantee under the Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992);
 - (b) registration as a non-governmental organisation with the Department of Social Welfare and the Registrar-General;
 - (c) registration with the Ghana Revenue Authority for purposes of tax exemption available to charitable institutions;
 - (d) registration with any other competent authority in furtherance of the Movement's objects.

6.2 Powers

- (1) The Movement shall, in pursuit of its vision and mission, have the power to:
 - (a) open, operate, and close bank and mobile-money accounts in its own name;
 - (b) receive donations, grants, sponsorships, and other lawful financial contributions;
 - (c) enter into memoranda of understanding, partnerships, and contracts with public, private, and non-governmental bodies;
 - (d) acquire, hold, manage, and dispose of property, real and personal, in furtherance of its objects;
 - (e) employ, engage, or commission persons for the discharge of its work;
 - (f) publish reports, books, periodicals, audio-visual material, and digital content;
 - (g) convene events, fora, conferences, and ceremonies;
 - (h) do all such other lawful acts as are consistent with the objects of the Movement.
- (2) All powers of the Movement shall be exercised solely through its duly constituted organs, and no individual member or officer shall purport to exercise any such power in his or her personal capacity.

6.3 Liabilities and Indemnity



- (1) The personal liability of any member or officer of the Movement, in respect of any act or omission done in good faith in the performance of his or her duties under this Constitution, shall be limited to the maximum extent permitted by law.
- (2) The Movement shall, to the extent of its lawful resources, indemnify any officer against any cost, expense, or claim incurred in the bona fide discharge of his or her duties; provided that this indemnity shall not extend to any liability arising from gross negligence, wilful misconduct, fraud, or dishonesty.
- (3) No member shall be personally liable for the debts, obligations, or liabilities of the Movement save in cases of personal guarantee or fraud.



ARTICLE 7 — LOGO, SEAL, MOTTO AND IDENTITY

7.1 Logo

- (1) The official logo of the Movement is the BYM logo as depicted on the cover page of this Constitution, comprising the figure of a young person standing within a circular motif, displayed in the official colours of the Movement, and bearing the inscriptions "BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT" and "VOLUNTEERING FOR CHANGE".
- (2) The said logo shall be used on all official documents, communications, branded materials, banners, and digital platforms of the Movement.

7.2 Official Colours

The official colours of the Movement, derived from the BYM logo, are:

- (1) Deep Teal — being the dominant brand colour, hexadecimal code #003334;
- (2) Steel Blue — being a secondary brand colour, hexadecimal code #336799;
- (3) Crimson Red — being a secondary brand colour, hexadecimal code #990100;
- (4) White and Black — being supporting brand colours.

These colours, in their hexadecimal designation, shall constitute the official palette and shall be used in all branded materials of the Movement.

7.3 Motto

The motto of the Movement is "VOLUNTEERING FOR CHANGE".

7.4 Official Seal

- (1) The Movement shall maintain an official seal which shall bear the BYM logo and the words "OFFICIAL SEAL — BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT".
- (2) The custody of the seal shall be vested in the Secretary-General, who shall affix it only upon the written authority of the President or by resolution of the Cabinet.
- (3) Every document executed under seal shall be witnessed by the President or, in his or her absence, by the First Vice President, and countersigned by the Secretary-General.

7.5 Protection of Identity

- (1) No person shall, without the prior written authorisation of the Cabinet, use the name, logo, seal, motto, or any other identifying mark of the Movement for any commercial, political, or personal purpose.
- (2) The Cabinet may take all lawful steps, including legal proceedings, to protect the identity and reputation of the Movement.





ARTICLE 8 — GEOGRAPHICAL JURISDICTION AND COMMUNITIES

8.1 Jurisdiction

- (1) The geographical jurisdiction of the Movement shall be Sefwi Bekwai town and the thirty-one (31) surrounding sub-communities falling within the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Area in the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipality of the Western North Region of the Republic of Ghana.
- (2) The complete schedule of the thirty-two (32) Communities forming the operational reach of the Movement is set out in Schedule II of this Constitution.

8.2 Variation of Jurisdiction

- (1) The Cabinet may, with the prior consent of the Traditional Advisory Council and by a resolution of two-thirds of its membership, recommend to the Annual General Assembly the inclusion of additional communities within the operational reach of the Movement.
- (2) Any such variation shall be effected by amendment of Schedule II in accordance with Article 32.

8.3 Equality of Communities

- (1) Every Community within the jurisdiction of the Movement shall enjoy equal status, equal entitlement to representation, and equal access to the services and programmes of the Movement, irrespective of size, location, or population.
- (2) No Community shall be regarded as superior to or more important than any other within the structures of the Movement.



PART III — MEMBERSHIP

ARTICLE 9 — CATEGORIES OF MEMBERSHIP

9.1 Categories

Membership of the Movement shall consist of the following categories:

- (1) Founding Members — being those persons who participated in the Founding Convention and whose names are entered in the Founding Register.
- (2) Ordinary Members — being persons aged eighteen (18) to forty-five (45) years inclusive who, in accordance with the United Nations age range for youth, satisfy the eligibility criteria set out in Article 10.
- (3) Parliamentary Members — being young persons aged ten (10) to seventeen (17) years admitted to the Bekwai Youth Parliament under Article 19.
- (4) Honorary Members — being persons of distinction whose contribution to the community or to the objects of the Movement merits recognition, admitted by resolution of the Cabinet upon the nomination of any Cabinet member.
- (5) Patron Members — being members of the Traditional Advisory Council and other dignitaries appointed under Article 22.
- (6) Associate Members — being persons resident outside the Movement's jurisdiction (including diaspora) who wish to support the work of the Movement and who have been admitted as such by the Cabinet.

9.2 Age Range — UN Standard

In conformity with the standard adopted by the United Nations and in particular the African Union Youth Charter (2006), the age range for Ordinary Membership of the Movement is fixed at eighteen (18) to forty-five (45) years inclusive. This range, being the operational age of full membership in the Assembly, shall not be reduced save by amendment of this Constitution.

On the Age Range

The fixing of the youth age range at 18 to 45 years inclusive accords with the African Union Youth Charter (2006) and reflects the operational reality of community development in Sefwi Bekwai, where leadership, household responsibility, and economic productivity span a wider age spectrum than international youth norms typically capture.





ARTICLE 10 — ELIGIBILITY, ADMISSION AND CONDUCT

10.1 General Eligibility

To be eligible for admission as an Ordinary Member of the Movement, a person shall:

- (1) be a citizen of the Republic of Ghana, or a lawful resident thereof;
- (2) be aged not less than eighteen (18) years and not more than forty-five (45) years at the date of application;
- (3) subscribe in writing to the vision, mission, and core values of the Movement set out in Article 4;
- (4) undertake to abide by this Constitution, by all Standing Orders, By-Laws, and Regulations made hereunder, and by the Code of Conduct contained in Schedule IV;
- (5) be of sound mind and not be subject to any disqualification under the laws of the Republic;
- (6) not have been convicted by any court of a felony involving dishonesty or moral turpitude in the immediately preceding five (5) years.

10.2 Application Procedure

- (1) An application for membership shall be made in writing in such form as the Cabinet may from time to time prescribe, and shall be accompanied by:
 - (a) two passport-size photographs of the applicant;
 - (b) a copy of a valid national identification document;
 - (c) where applicable, evidence of residency in a Community;
 - (d) any registration fee as may be prescribed by the Cabinet from time to time;
 - (e) a signed undertaking to abide by this Constitution and the Code of Conduct.
- (2) The Secretary-General shall maintain a register of all applications, recording the date of receipt, the disposition, and the date of admission or rejection.

10.3 Admission

- (1) Every application for membership shall be reviewed by the Membership Sub-Committee of the Cabinet within twenty-one (21) days of receipt.
- (2) The Membership Sub-Committee shall recommend to the Cabinet the admission, deferral, or rejection of each applicant; and the Cabinet shall, within fourteen (14) days thereafter, take a final decision on each recommendation.
- (3) Upon admission, the new member shall be issued a Letter of Admission, an official Membership Card, and shall take the Oath of Service set out in Schedule I before the Cabinet or before such officer as the President may designate.



10.4 Specific Eligibility for Community Representation

Where a member seeks to represent a Community in any official capacity, in addition to general eligibility, the said member shall:

- (1)** have been resident in the said Community for a period of not less than two (2) years immediately preceding the date of nomination;
- (2)** produce written endorsement from the Sub-Chief or recognised traditional authority of the Community;
- (3)** submit to a vetting interview before the Vetting Panel constituted under Article 30;
- (4)** have no record of community misconduct or dispute unresolved as at the date of nomination.

10.5 Conduct of Members

Every member shall, at all times, conduct themselves in a manner consistent with the dignity of the Movement and shall, in particular:

- (1)** refrain from political party campaigning, endorsement, or partisan activity in the name of the Movement;
- (2)** maintain the confidentiality of internal Movement matters where so required by the Cabinet;
- (3)** comply with all directives lawfully issued by the Cabinet, the Speaker, or the relevant Unit head;
- (4)** treat all fellow members, traditional authorities, and members of the public with respect and courtesy;
- (5)** not use his or her position to obtain personal financial advantage, gratification, or favour.



ARTICLE 11 — RIGHTS, PRIVILEGES AND DUTIES OF MEMBERS

11.1 Rights of Ordinary Members

Subject to the provisions of this Constitution, every Ordinary Member shall be entitled to:

- (1) attend, speak at, and vote at the Annual General Assembly and at any duly convened meeting at which his or her presence is provided for by this Constitution;
- (2) stand for election to any office of the Movement for which he or she is qualified;
- (3) participate in any Unit, Volunteer Action Team, or programme of the Movement;
- (4) receive notice of all Annual General Assemblies and other gatherings open to the membership;
- (5) inspect, on reasonable notice, the public records, financial reports, and resolutions of the Movement;
- (6) access training, mentoring, and capacity-building opportunities offered by the Movement;
- (7) use the official identity of the Movement in such manner and to such extent as the Cabinet may from time to time approve in writing.

11.2 Privileges of Particular Categories

- (1) Founding Members shall, in addition to the rights set out in Clause 11.1, be entitled to:
 - (a) permanent recognition in the Founding Register of the Movement;
 - (b) lifetime invitation to all major ceremonies and anniversaries of the Movement;
 - (c) consultative voice on any proposed amendment to this Constitution under Article 32.
- (2) Honorary and Patron Members shall be entitled to such privileges as the Cabinet may, from time to time, by resolution determine; provided that they shall not be entitled to vote at the Annual General Assembly save where this Constitution so provides.
- (3) Associate Members may participate in the activities of the Movement and contribute thereto, but shall not be entitled to vote or to hold elective office save where this Constitution so provides.

11.3 Duties of Members

Every member of the Movement shall:

- (1) uphold and obey this Constitution and the Code of Conduct;
- (2) pay all dues, contributions, or levies properly imposed under this Constitution;
- (3) participate, to the best of his or her ability, in the activities of the Movement;
- (4) promote the good name and reputation of the Movement;



- (5) support and not undermine, by word or conduct, the lawful actions of the Cabinet, Parliament, or any other organ of the Movement;
- (6) report any conduct contrary to this Constitution or to the Code of Conduct to the Home Secretary.

11.4 Residency for Representation

- (1) For the purposes of representing a Community in the Cabinet, the Community Intelligence Network, or any Community Representative role, a member shall, save as otherwise provided in this Constitution, satisfy a continuous primary residency requirement of two (2) years immediately preceding nomination.
- (2) For Parliamentary Members, the residency requirement is six (6) months, provided that the Member is enrolled at a school serving the Community in question.
- (3) Acceptable proof of residency shall be:
 - (a) a written endorsement from the Sub-Chief or recognised traditional authority;
 - (b) a Ghana national identification document showing the residential address;
 - (c) school enrolment records (in the case of Parliamentary candidates);
 - (d) the written testimony of at least two (2) recognised community elders, in such form as the Secretary-General may prescribe.



ARTICLE 12 — CESSATION, SUSPENSION AND EXPULSION

12.1 Cessation of Membership

Membership of a person shall cease upon the occurrence of any of the following:

- (1) the death of the member;
- (2) the resignation of the member, given by written notice to the Secretary-General;
- (3) the failure of an Ordinary Member to pay dues, levies, or contributions for a continuous period of twelve (12) months, after the giving of written notice and the lapse of the period of grace;
- (4) the conviction of a member by any court of a felony involving dishonesty or moral turpitude;
- (5) the expulsion of a member under Article 31;
- (6) the dissolution of the Movement under Article 33.

12.2 Suspension

- (1) The Home Secretary may, in consultation with the President and the Secretary-General, suspend any member pending investigation of any alleged breach of this Constitution or of the Code of Conduct.
- (2) A suspension under sub-clause (1) shall:
 - (a) be communicated in writing to the member and shall state the grounds of suspension;
 - (b) not exceed thirty (30) days save with the express approval of the Cabinet;
 - (c) be subject to a fair hearing as provided under Article 31.

12.3 Expulsion

- (1) Expulsion shall be the most severe sanction available against a member of the Movement and shall be reserved for grave breaches of this Constitution, including:
 - (a) fraud, theft, or financial impropriety committed in the name or affairs of the Movement;
 - (b) conviction by any court of a felony involving dishonesty or moral turpitude;
 - (c) use of the Movement's name, logo, or resources for political party campaigning or partisan purposes;
 - (d) wilful and persistent disobedience of lawful directives of the Cabinet or the Annual General Assembly;
 - (e) such other conduct as the Cabinet shall, by reasoned resolution, determine to be incompatible with continued membership.



- (2) No member shall be expelled save after a fair hearing in accordance with Article 31, including the opportunity to be heard, to be represented, and to lead evidence.
- (3) An expulsion decision shall be ratified by the Cabinet by a two-thirds majority and shall be subject to appeal to the Annual General Assembly.

12.4 Reinstatement

A member whose membership has lapsed under Clause 12.1(3) may apply for reinstatement upon settling outstanding dues, and the Cabinet may, in its discretion, grant or refuse such application. A member expelled under Clause 12.3 shall not apply for reinstatement until two (2) years have elapsed from the date of expulsion.



PART IV – THE BYM YOUTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY (EXECUTIVE)

ARTICLE 13 – ESTABLISHMENT AND COMPOSITION

13.1 Establishment

- (1) There is hereby established the BYM Youth General Assembly (in this Constitution referred to as "the Assembly") as the executive organ of the Movement, comprising the Cabinet of Secretaries of State and being responsible for the day-to-day strategic governance, administration, project implementation, and operational management of the Movement.
- (2) The Assembly is constituted exclusively as an executive body. The deliberative, debating, and youth-voice functions of the Movement are vested in the Bekwai Youth Parliament, established under Part V.

13.2 Membership Age Range

- (1) Membership of the Assembly shall be restricted to persons aged between eighteen (18) and forty-five (45) years inclusive at the time of appointment, in conformity with the African Union Youth Charter (2006) and the United Nations age range for youth.
- (2) An officer of the Assembly who attains the age of forty-six (46) during the currency of his or her term shall be entitled to complete the said term, but shall not be eligible for reappointment thereafter to any office of the Assembly.

13.3 Composition

The Assembly shall comprise:

- (1) the Cabinet, comprising the offices set out in Article 15 and Schedule III;
- (2) Community Representatives, being one (1) Council Representative for each of the thirty-two (32) Communities listed in Schedule II;
- (3) such other officers as the Cabinet may, from time to time, by resolution appoint for specific functions.



ARTICLE 14 — POWERS, FUNCTIONS AND AUTHORITY

14.1 Executive Authority

- (1) The executive authority of the Movement is vested in the Assembly and shall be exercised through the Cabinet under the leadership of the President.
- (2) The Cabinet shall be the supreme decision-making body of the Movement on all executive matters, subject only to:
 - (a) the supremacy of this Constitution;
 - (b) the resolutions of the Annual General Assembly;
 - (c) the lawful directives of the Founding Leadership in respect of strategic matters reserved to it under this Constitution.

14.2 Functions

The functions of the Assembly include, without limitation:

- (1) to formulate, approve, and oversee the implementation of the strategic plan of the Movement;
- (2) to receive, deliberate upon, and respond to Youth Recommendations from the Bekwai Youth Parliament;
- (3) to approve the annual budget, financial plan, and audited accounts of the Movement;
- (4) to authorise the establishment, modification, or dissolution of Units and Volunteer Action Teams;
- (5) to negotiate, approve, and execute partnerships, memoranda of understanding, and contracts on behalf of the Movement;
- (6) to issue Letters of Appointment to all Officers of the Movement;
- (7) to receive monthly reports from the Community Intelligence Network and to act upon the same;
- (8) to ensure compliance with the laws of the Republic and with this Constitution;
- (9) to discharge such other functions as may be conferred by this Constitution or by resolution of the Annual General Assembly.

14.3 Reservations

Notwithstanding the executive authority of the Cabinet, the following matters shall not be undertaken by the Cabinet without the prior approval of the Annual General Assembly:

- (1) any amendment of this Constitution under Article 32;
- (2) any decision to incorporate the Movement under any law of the Republic;
- (3) any acquisition or disposal of immovable property of a value exceeding such threshold as the Annual General Assembly may from time to time prescribe;



(4) any decision to dissolve the Movement under Article 33.



ARTICLE 15 — OFFICES OF THE CABINET

15.1 The President

- (1) The President of the Youth General Assembly shall be the principal executive officer of the Movement and shall:
 - (a) preside over all sittings of the Cabinet and the Annual General Assembly;
 - (b) represent the Movement at all formal occasions;
 - (c) sign all documents executed in the name of the Movement, jointly with the Secretary-General;
 - (d) appoint, with the advice of the Founding Leadership, the Secretaries of State of the Cabinet;
 - (e) convene meetings of the Cabinet and of the Annual General Assembly;
 - (f) exercise such other functions as are conferred by this Constitution.
- (2) Eligibility: A candidate for President shall be aged twenty-two (22) to thirty-five (35) years, shall have been a member of the Movement for not less than two (2) years, shall be of demonstrated leadership capacity, and shall be a Resident of a Community for not less than two (2) years.
- (3) Term: The President shall hold office for a term of two (2) years and may be re-elected for one further term, after which he or she shall not be eligible for re-election to that office.

15.2 The First Vice President (Deputy Prime Minister)

- (1) The First Vice President shall:
 - (a) deputise the President in all functions and assume Presidential duties in the President's absence;
 - (b) chair the Cabinet in the absence of the President;
 - (c) oversee the cross-portfolio coordination of all Secretaries of State;
 - (d) exercise such other functions as the President may delegate.
- (2) Eligibility: A candidate for First Vice President shall be aged twenty (20) to thirty-three (33) years, shall have been a member for not less than one (1) year, and shall be a Resident of a Community for not less than two (2) years.

15.3 The Second Vice President (Minister of State)

- (1) The Second Vice President shall:
 - (a) oversee the Community Intelligence Network and all data operations of the Movement;
 - (b) manage the Director of Community Intelligence and the Data Quality Officer;



- (c) ensure the timely compilation and submission of monthly Community Reports;
 - (d) exercise such other functions as the President may delegate.
- (2) Eligibility shall be as for the First Vice President; data literacy or research background is desirable.

15.4 The Secretary-General (Cabinet Secretary / Chief of Staff)

- (1) The Secretary-General shall be the chief administrative officer of the Movement and shall:
- (a) be the custodian of all official records, documents, and registers of the Movement;
 - (b) record the minutes of all sittings of the Cabinet and the Annual General Assembly;
 - (c) manage all official correspondence;
 - (d) register all new members and maintain the Members' Register;
 - (e) be the custodian of the Official Seal.
- (2) Eligibility: Aged twenty (20) to thirty-five (35) years, possessed of strong writing and administrative skills, and a member of the Movement for not less than one (1) year.

15.5 The Deputy Secretary-General

The Deputy Secretary-General shall assist the Secretary-General, manage digital communications, and maintain the Movement's website and digital records. Eligibility: Aged eighteen (18) to thirty-three (33) years, with digital literacy.

15.6 The Treasurer (Chancellor of the Exchequer)

- (1) The Treasurer shall:
- (a) be the chief financial officer of the Movement;
 - (b) manage all funds, accounts, and financial records;
 - (c) prepare and present the quarterly and annual financial reports;
 - (d) countersign all financial transactions above such threshold as the Cabinet may from time to time prescribe;
 - (e) maintain the Financial Register.
- (2) Eligibility: Aged twenty (20) to forty (40) years, possessed of financial literacy and a trustworthy track record, and a member for not less than one (1) year.

15.7 The Deputy Treasurer (Financial Secretary to the Treasury)

The Deputy Treasurer shall assist the Treasurer, manage petty cash, track project-level expenditure, and reconcile community project budgets.

15.8 Secretary for Education and Youth Development (Secretary of State for Education)



The Secretary for Education shall lead the Education and Youth Development Unit, oversee the Youth Parliament programme in conjunction with the Speaker, manage school partnerships, and run the Youth Development Academy.

15.9 Secretary for Health and Social Welfare

The Secretary for Health shall lead the Health and Social Welfare Unit, coordinate community health campaigns, manage child protection protocols, and oversee social welfare volunteer teams.

15.10 Secretary for Economic Affairs

The Secretary for Economic Affairs shall lead the Economic Empowerment and Employment Unit, coordinate apprenticeship, microfinance linkage, and youth entrepreneurship programmes across all Communities.

15.11 Secretary for Environment, Sanitation and Climate

The Secretary for Environment shall lead the Environment Unit, manage Volunteer Action Teams for sanitation, tree-planting, and climate education, and coordinate the Movement's response to environmental challenges.

15.12 Secretary for Communications, Media and Partnerships

The Secretary for Communications shall lead the Communications Unit, manage all public communications, social media, newsletters, press releases, and the BYM website, and coordinate diaspora outreach.

15.13 The Home Secretary (Secretary of State for the Interior)

(1) The Home Secretary shall:

- (a) manage internal Movement security, conflict resolution, and member conduct;
- (b) enforce the Code of Conduct in Schedule IV;
- (c) investigate grievances and misconduct reports;
- (d) chair the Disciplinary Sub-Committee.

(2) Eligibility: Aged twenty-two (22) to forty (40) years, of strong integrity, respected by peers, and a member for not less than two (2) years.

15.14 Secretary for Foreign Affairs and Partnerships (Foreign Secretary)

The Secretary for Foreign Affairs shall manage all external partnerships with non-governmental organisations, government bodies, diaspora networks, and international organisations, and shall lead partnership negotiations and the execution of memoranda of understanding.

15.15 Secretary for Women and Gender Equality (Minister for Women and Equalities)



The Secretary for Women shall ensure that minimum representation thresholds for women across the structures of the Movement are met, lead women-focused development programmes, and report gender equality metrics quarterly to the Cabinet.

15.16 Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs (Leader of the House)

The Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs shall manage the relationship between the Cabinet and the Bekwai Youth Parliament, schedule Parliamentary sessions in consultation with the Speaker, convey Cabinet decisions to Parliament, and facilitate Parliamentary procedure.

15.17 The Organiser (Chief Whip)

The Organiser shall coordinate all events, sittings, and community outreach of the Movement, manage logistics, ensure the attendance of members at meetings, and maintain attendance records.

15.18 The Deputy Organiser (Deputy Chief Whip)

The Deputy Organiser shall assist the Organiser and shall manage sub-community event coordination.

15.19 Nasara / Inter-Community Liaison Officer (Minister for Communities)

The Nasara Officer shall manage the Movement's relations with Muslim, Zongo, and minority communities, ensuring that every sub-group is represented and heard within the Assembly.

15.20 Schedule of Cabinet Offices

The full schedule of Cabinet offices, with their respective qualifications and SDG alignment, is set out in Schedule III of this Constitution.

15.21 Acting Appointments

- (1)** Where any Cabinet office is vacant or where the holder is unable, by reason of absence or incapacity, to perform the functions thereof, the President may appoint another Cabinet member to act in that office until such time as a substantive appointment is made or the holder resumes duty.
- (2)** An acting appointment under sub-clause (1) shall not exceed ninety (90) days save with the express approval of the Cabinet.



ARTICLE 16 — CABINET PROCEDURE AND SITTINGS

16.1 Frequency of Sittings

- (1) The Cabinet shall ordinarily meet not less than once each calendar month.
- (2) Extraordinary sittings of the Cabinet may be convened by the President at any time, and shall be so convened upon the written request of not less than five (5) Cabinet members.

16.2 Notice of Sittings

- (1) Save in cases of emergency, every sitting of the Cabinet shall be preceded by a written notice of not less than seven (7) days, accompanied by an agenda of the matters to be considered.
- (2) Notice may be given in writing, by electronic mail, or by such other means of communication as the Cabinet may from time to time approve.

16.3 Quorum

- (1) The quorum for any sitting of the Cabinet shall be one-half of its members plus one (1).
- (2) No business shall be transacted at any sitting unless quorum is present at the time of transaction.

16.4 Decisions

- (1) Save where this Constitution requires a special majority, decisions of the Cabinet shall be taken by simple majority of those present and voting.
- (2) In the event of an equality of votes, the President shall have a second or casting vote.
- (3) Decisions of the Cabinet shall be recorded in the Minutes Register, signed by the President and the Secretary-General, and circulated to all Cabinet members within fourteen (14) days.

16.5 Annual General Assembly

- (1) The Movement shall hold an Annual General Assembly each year, between the months of January and March, at such place and time as the Cabinet shall determine.
- (2) Notice of the Annual General Assembly, accompanied by the agenda, the audited financial statement of the previous year, and the strategic plan for the current year, shall be given to all members not less than twenty-one (21) days in advance.
- (3) The functions of the Annual General Assembly include:
 - (a) the receipt of the President's annual report;
 - (b) the receipt and adoption of the audited financial statement;
 - (c) the approval of the strategic plan and budget for the year;
 - (d) the consideration of any proposed amendment to this Constitution;



- (e) the consideration of any matter referred to it by the Cabinet, the Speaker, or by petition of not less than twenty (20) members.



ARTICLE 17 — TENURE, REMOVAL AND VACANCY

17.1 Tenure

The tenure of each Cabinet office shall be as set out in Schedule III, but shall not, save for the Secretary-General, exceed two (2) consecutive terms of two (2) years each.

17.2 Vacation of Office

A Cabinet office shall be vacated upon the occurrence of any of the following:

- (1) the expiry of the holder's term;
- (2) the resignation of the holder, given by written notice to the President;
- (3) the death of the holder;
- (4) the removal of the holder under Clause 17.3;
- (5) the cessation of the holder's membership of the Movement under Article 12;
- (6) the holder ceasing to be eligible by reason of age, residency, or any other qualifying criterion.

17.3 Removal from Office

(1) A Cabinet officer may be removed from office for:

- (a) misconduct in office;
- (b) incapacity to perform the duties of the office;
- (c) conviction by any court of a felony involving dishonesty or moral turpitude;
- (d) wilful breach of this Constitution or of the Code of Conduct;
- (e) absenteeism from three (3) consecutive Cabinet sittings without leave.

(2) Removal of a Cabinet officer shall be effected by:

- (a) the institution of proceedings under Article 31 by the Home Secretary or by petition of not less than five (5) Cabinet members;
- (b) a fair hearing before the Disciplinary Sub-Committee;
- (c) the passing of a resolution by two-thirds majority of the Cabinet.

(3) An officer removed under this Clause may appeal to the Annual General Assembly within thirty (30) days of removal.

17.4 Filling of Vacancies

A vacancy in any Cabinet office, howsoever caused, shall be filled within sixty (60) days in accordance with the appointment procedure set out in Article 30.



PART V — THE BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT (LEGISLATIVE)

ARTICLE 18 — ESTABLISHMENT OF THE BEKWAI YOUTH PARLIAMENT

18.1 Establishment

- (1) There is hereby established the Bekwai Youth Parliament (in this Constitution referred to as "Parliament") as the legislative and deliberative chamber of the Movement, modelled, with such adaptations as are necessary, on the Westminster system of parliamentary governance.
- (2) Parliament shall be the principal forum for the voice of children and young persons aged ten (10) to seventeen (17) years inclusive, drawn from each of the thirty-two (32) Communities, and shall serve as a structured platform for civic education, deliberation, and the formulation of Youth Recommendations to the Cabinet.

18.2 Independence

- (1) Parliament shall, in the discharge of its functions, be independent of the Cabinet, save in matters expressly reserved to the Cabinet by this Constitution.
- (2) No member of the Cabinet shall, save where this Constitution provides, attend a sitting of Parliament otherwise than upon invitation of the Speaker.

18.3 Functions

The functions of Parliament include:

- (1) to debate and deliberate upon matters of community concern raised by Parliament Members or referred to it by the Cabinet;
- (2) to adopt formal Youth Recommendations and submit them to the Cabinet;
- (3) to provide structured civic education and democratic training for young persons;
- (4) to provide a parliamentary voice for the children of all thirty-two (32) Communities;
- (5) to receive and respond to communications from the Cabinet on matters affecting children and young persons.



ARTICLE 19 — COMPOSITION, MEMBERSHIP AND OFFICERS

19.1 Composition

- (1) Parliament shall consist of thirty-two (32) Community Parliament Members, being one (1) Member elected or nominated from each Community, together with the Officers of Parliament constituted under Clause 19.3.
- (2) Membership shall be restricted to persons aged ten (10) to seventeen (17) years inclusive.

19.2 Eligibility

To be eligible as a Parliament Member, a person shall:

- (1) be aged not less than ten (10) and not more than seventeen (17) years at the date of nomination;
- (2) be resident in, or attend a school serving, the Community he or she seeks to represent, for not less than six (6) months;
- (3) be nominated by the headmaster of his or her school, by a teacher, by a Sub-Chief, or by a recognised community elder;
- (4) submit a written parental or guardian consent in such form as the Secretary for Education and Youth Development shall prescribe;
- (5) satisfy the Secretary for Education and Youth Development at a brief interview that he or she has the necessary maturity and motivation.

19.3 Officers of Parliament

(1) The Officers of Parliament shall be:

- (a) the Speaker — being the principal presiding officer of Parliament;
 - (b) the Deputy Speaker — being the deputy of the Speaker;
 - (c) the Majority Leader — being the leader of the majority caucus;
 - (d) the Minority / Opposition Leader — being the leader of the minority caucus;
 - (e) the Clerk of Parliament — being the chief recorder of Parliament's proceedings.
- (2) The Speaker shall be aged sixteen (16) or seventeen (17) years and shall be elected by Parliament from amongst its members at its first sitting.
- (3) The Deputy Speaker, Majority Leader, Minority Leader, and Clerk shall similarly be elected by Parliament from amongst its members.
- (4) The term of an Officer of Parliament shall be one (1) year, renewable, provided that no person shall hold office beyond the age of seventeen (17) years.



19.4 Parental Consent

- (1) No person shall be admitted as a Parliament Member without the prior written consent of his or her parent or legal guardian.
- (2) Parental consent shall be capable of being withdrawn at any time, in which case the Member shall cease to hold office forthwith.



ARTICLE 20 – PROCEDURE, SITTINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

20.1 Sittings

- (1) Parliament shall sit not less than three (3) times each year, in periods aligned with the school terms of the Republic of Ghana.
- (2) Each sitting shall not exceed three (3) hours' duration.
- (3) Sittings shall be conducted in the English language, with explanation provided in Twi where necessary.

20.2 Procedure

- (1) Parliament shall, at its first sitting, adopt Standing Orders for the regulation of its proceedings.
- (2) Until such Standing Orders are adopted, Parliament shall be guided by such modified Westminster procedures as the Speaker, in consultation with the Secretary for Education and Youth Development, shall determine.

20.3 Quorum

The quorum for any sitting of Parliament shall be one-third of the total membership.

20.4 Youth Recommendations

- (1) Parliament may, by simple majority of those present and voting, adopt formal Youth Recommendations addressed to the Cabinet.
- (2) A Youth Recommendation shall be transmitted to the Cabinet by the Clerk through the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs, and the Cabinet shall, within sixty (60) days, formally respond in writing to the Speaker.
- (3) Where the Cabinet declines to act upon a Youth Recommendation, it shall provide written reasons for its decision.



ARTICLE 21 — PRIVILEGES, SUPERVISION AND SAFEGUARDING

21.1 Privileges of Members

Members of Parliament shall enjoy:

- (1) freedom of speech in any sitting, subject to the rules of order;
- (2) exemption from any school examination duty during a duly notified sitting;
- (3) an official Letter of Appointment, identification, and recognition;
- (4) access to such training, mentoring, and exposure programmes as the Movement may organise.

21.2 Supervision and Safeguarding

- (1) All sittings of Parliament shall be supervised by the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs and at least one (1) other Cabinet member.
- (2) Sub-Chiefs of the Communities represented shall be formally invited as Guests of Honour to every sitting.
- (3) The Movement shall maintain a Safeguarding Policy in respect of children participating in Parliament, in compliance with the laws of the Republic relating to child welfare and protection.
- (4) No adult shall, save with the express approval of the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs and in the presence of at least one (1) other adult, hold any private meeting with a Parliament Member.

21.3 Discipline of Members

A Parliament Member may be removed from office for grave misconduct, upon a fair hearing before the Speaker and the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs, and with the prior knowledge of the Member's parent or guardian.



PART VI – TRADITIONAL AND COMMUNITY GOVERNANCE INTERFACE

ARTICLE 22 – THE TRADITIONAL ADVISORY COUNCIL

22.1 Establishment

- (1) There is hereby established the Traditional Advisory Council (in this Constitution referred to as "the TAC"), being the highest honorary body within the structure of the Movement.
- (2) The TAC shall not exercise executive authority but shall command moral authority, community trust, and cultural legitimacy. It shall serve as the guardian of the Movement's values, the protector of its non-political status, and the bridge between the Movement and the traditional governance system.

22.2 Membership

The TAC shall comprise:

- (1) the Paramount Chief of the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Area, or his designated representative, as Patron;
- (2) the Sub-Chiefs of each of the thirty-one (31) sub-communities, each as Community Patron of his area;
- (3) the Queenmother of Sefwi Bekwai, or her designated representative, as Women's Patron;
- (4) the Municipal Chief Executive of the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipal Assembly, or his designated representative, as Government Liaison Patron;
- (5) such other persons of distinction as the Cabinet, with the consent of the Patron, shall from time to time invite.

22.3 Functions

The TAC shall:

- (1) advise the Movement on matters of tradition, culture, and community sensitivity;
- (2) receive the President's six-monthly Report on the affairs of the Movement;
- (3) preside, by its Patron, at the Annual Durbar of the Movement;
- (4) exercise such other functions as may be conferred by this Constitution.



ARTICLE 23 — ENGAGEMENT WITH TRADITIONAL AUTHORITIES

23.1 Formal Permission

- (1) Before any community-level activity is undertaken in a Community, the Movement shall pay a formal courtesy call upon the Sub-Chief of the said Community and shall present a written letter of introduction.
- (2) The permission of the Sub-Chief shall be sought, and his endorsement publicised within the Community.

23.2 Letters of Endorsement

All Community Representative nominations shall be supported by a written letter of endorsement (or in the absence thereof, verbal endorsement properly recorded) from the Sub-Chief or recognised traditional authority of the Community.

23.3 Reporting to Sub-Chiefs

Community Intelligence Officers shall share a summary of their Monthly Community Reports with the Sub-Chief of their Community before submission to the Director of Intelligence.

23.4 Annual Durbar

- (1) The Movement shall, in conjunction with the TAC, hold an Annual Durbar at which:
 - (a) the President shall present the State of the Community Report;
 - (b) the SDG Progress Report shall be presented;
 - (c) outstanding members and Communities shall be recognised.
- (2) The Annual Durbar shall be held in conjunction with, or in proximity to, the Allue (Yam) Festival of the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Area, in such manner as the Patron of the TAC shall approve.



ARTICLE 24 — ENGAGEMENT WITH PUBLIC AUTHORITIES

24.1 Non-Political Engagement

- (1) The Movement shall engage with the public authorities of the Republic of Ghana, including the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipal Assembly, the Western North Regional Coordinating Council, and the various agencies of the Government of Ghana, on a strictly non-political and non-partisan basis.
- (2) No officer of the Movement shall, in any official capacity, endorse, campaign for, or against any political party, candidate, or partisan position.

24.2 Memoranda of Understanding

The Movement may, through the President and the Secretary-General, execute memoranda of understanding with public authorities for purposes of:

- (1) joint community development projects;
- (2) co-ordination of resources and activities;
- (3) data-sharing in respect of community needs and resources;
- (4) such other matters as may be in the lawful interest of the Movement.

24.3 Reporting

The Movement shall, where required by the laws of the Republic, submit annual reports to the relevant public authorities and shall comply with all lawful regulatory requirements.



PART VII — INSTITUTIONAL ORGANS AND OPERATIONS

ARTICLE 25 — UNITS, VOLUNTEER ACTION TEAMS AND CIN

25.1 Units

- (1) The operational structure of the Movement is organised through Units, each of which is led by a Cabinet Secretary and aligned to particular Sustainable Development Goals.
- (2) The Units of the Movement, as constituted at the founding of the Movement, are:
 - (a) the Governance and Civic Affairs Unit;
 - (b) the Education and Youth Development Unit;
 - (c) the Health and Social Welfare Unit;
 - (d) the Economic Empowerment and Employment Unit;
 - (e) the Environment, Sanitation and Climate Unit;
 - (f) the Community Intelligence and Data Unit;
 - (g) the Communications, Media and Partnerships Unit.
- (3) The Cabinet may, by resolution, establish additional Units or modify the mandate of existing Units.

25.2 Volunteer Action Teams

- (1) There shall be Volunteer Action Teams operating under the relevant Cabinet Secretary, focused on:
 - (a) Sanitation and Public Health Campaigns;
 - (b) Education Support and Tutoring;
 - (c) Health Awareness and Mental Health;
 - (d) Youth Employment and Skills;
 - (e) Environmental Action and Tree-Planting;
 - (f) Social Welfare and Vulnerable Persons.
- (2) Each Volunteer Action Team shall be led by a Team Lead appointed by the Organiser in consultation with the relevant Cabinet Secretary.



25.3 Community Intelligence Network (CIN)

(1) The Community Intelligence Network shall comprise:

- (a)** the Director of Community Intelligence;
- (b)** the Deputy Director of Intelligence;
- (c)** the Data Quality Officer;
- (d)** thirty-two (32) Community Intelligence Officers, being one (1) Officer for each Community.

(2) Every Community Intelligence Officer shall:

- (a)** submit a Monthly Community Intelligence Report in such form as the Director shall prescribe;
- (b)** share a summary of the said Report with the Sub-Chief of his or her Community;
- (c)** flag urgent issues to the Director immediately;
- (d)** maintain confidentiality of any sensitive information.



ARTICLE 26 — RECORDS, DATABASE AND PUBLICATIONS

26.1 Records System

- (1)** The Movement shall maintain a structured records management system, to be known as the BYM Community Intelligence and Records Database (CIRD), comprising five (5) Registers:
 - (a)** the Member Register, maintained by the Secretary-General;
 - (b)** the Community Intelligence Register, maintained by the Director of Intelligence;
 - (c)** the Project and Volunteer Register, maintained by the relevant Unit Secretary;
 - (d)** the Financial Register, maintained by the Treasurer;
 - (e)** the Traditional Authority and Partnership Register, maintained by the Secretary for Foreign Affairs.
- (2)** All Registers shall be maintained both in physical and digital form, with appropriate security and access controls.

26.2 Data Protection

- (1)** All personal data of members, officers, and other persons shall be collected, stored, processed, and disclosed in compliance with the Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843) of the Republic of Ghana.
- (2)** Personal data shall be accessible only to such officers as are duly authorised to access it for the discharge of their lawful duties.
- (3)** Community Intelligence data may be published in anonymised aggregate form only, save with the prior written consent of the persons concerned.

26.3 Publications

The Movement shall publish:

- (1)** a Quarterly State of the Community Report;
- (2)** an Annual SDG Progress Report;
- (3)** the audited annual financial statement;
- (4)** such other publications as the Cabinet may from time to time approve.



PART VIII — FINANCIAL ADMINISTRATION

ARTICLE 27 — SOURCES OF FUNDS AND FINANCIAL YEAR

27.1 Sources of Funds

The funds of the Movement shall be derived from:

- (1) membership dues, levies, and contributions;
- (2) donations, grants, and bequests from individuals, organisations, foundations, and development partners;
- (3) fundraising activities, including events and appeals;
- (4) income from publications, training programmes, and consultancy provided by the Movement;
- (5) interest and investment returns on funds held;
- (6) such other lawful sources as the Cabinet shall, from time to time, approve.

27.2 Application of Funds

- (1) All funds of the Movement shall be applied solely in furtherance of its objects and shall not, in any circumstance, be distributed to any individual member by way of profit or dividend.
- (2) Reasonable expenses incurred in the lawful discharge of duty may be reimbursed in accordance with such Expense Policy as the Cabinet shall, from time to time, adopt.

27.3 Financial Year

The financial year of the Movement shall commence on the first day of January and end on the thirty-first day of December of each year.



ARTICLE 28 — CUSTODY, BANKING AND AUTHORISED SIGNATORIES

28.1 Bank Accounts

- (1) The Movement shall maintain bank accounts with such banks in the Republic of Ghana as the Cabinet shall, from time to time, by resolution approve.
- (2) All cheques, transfer instructions, and electronic payment instructions of the Movement shall be signed by any two (2) of the following:
 - (a) the President;
 - (b) the Secretary-General;
 - (c) the Treasurer;
 - (d) such other Cabinet member as the Cabinet shall, by resolution, designate.

28.2 Mobile Money

The Movement may, with the approval of the Cabinet, maintain mobile money accounts and digital payment platforms; provided that the same shall be subject to authorised signatory rules and audit equivalent to those applying to bank accounts.

28.3 Cash Limits

- (1) The Cabinet shall, from time to time, set a cash holding limit beyond which no person shall hold cash on behalf of the Movement otherwise than as a deposit in a bank account or mobile money account.
- (2) All financial transactions exceeding such threshold as the Cabinet shall prescribe shall be countersigned by both the Treasurer and the President.



ARTICLE 29 – AUDIT AND FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY

29.1 External Audit

- (1) The accounts of the Movement shall be audited annually by an independent auditor appointed by the Cabinet on the recommendation of the Treasurer.
- (2) The auditor shall be a person qualified to act as such under the laws of the Republic and shall be independent of the Movement.
- (3) The audit report, together with the audited financial statement, shall be presented to the Annual General Assembly.

29.2 Internal Financial Controls

- (1) The Treasurer, with the approval of the Cabinet, shall establish and maintain a Financial Manual setting out:
 - (a) the procedure for the receipt and recording of funds;
 - (b) the procedure for the authorisation and recording of expenditure;
 - (c) the procedure for the maintenance of the Financial Register;
 - (d) the controls applicable to petty cash and project budgets;
 - (e) the rules applicable to the reimbursement of expenses.
- (2) Every officer with responsibility for funds shall comply with the Financial Manual.

29.3 Disclosure of Interest

- (1) Every Cabinet member, officer, and member having a personal financial interest in any matter before the Movement shall, at the earliest opportunity, declare such interest in writing to the Cabinet.
- (2) A person who has declared an interest under sub-clause (1) shall not vote on, nor seek to influence, the matter in question.



PART IX — ELECTIONS, APPOINTMENTS AND DISCIPLINE

ARTICLE 30 — ELECTIONS AND APPOINTMENTS

30.1 Vetting Panel

- (1) There shall be a Vetting Panel constituted to vet candidates for offices of the Movement, comprising:
- (a) the President or his or her nominee;
 - (b) the Secretary-General;
 - (c) the Home Secretary;
 - (d) one (1) member of the Traditional Advisory Council, nominated by the Patron.

30.2 Procedure

The procedure for the appointment of any officer of the Movement shall, save where this Constitution otherwise provides, comprise the following stages:

- (1) the formal opening of nominations by the Secretary-General;
- (2) the receipt of nominations within the prescribed window;
- (3) the vetting of all nominees by the Vetting Panel;
- (4) the recommendation of qualified candidates to the appointing authority;
- (5) the appointment by the appointing authority and the issuance of a Letter of Appointment;
- (6) the swearing-in of the appointee in accordance with Schedule I.

30.3 Election by Annual General Assembly

The election of the President and the Vice Presidents shall be conducted at the Annual General Assembly by secret ballot of Ordinary Members, with such procedures as the Secretary-General shall, by Standing Order, prescribe.

30.4 Appointment by President

The Secretaries of State, the Organiser, and other Cabinet members not elected at the Annual General Assembly shall be appointed by the President with the advice of the Founding Leadership.



ARTICLE 31 — CODE OF CONDUCT AND DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

31.1 The Code of Conduct

- (1) The full Code of Conduct, set out in Schedule IV of this Constitution, shall apply to every member, officer, and volunteer of the Movement.
- (2) Every person, on assumption of office or enrolment as a member, shall undertake in writing to abide by the Code of Conduct.

31.2 Disciplinary Sub-Committee

- (1) There shall be a Disciplinary Sub-Committee of the Cabinet, chaired by the Home Secretary and comprising:
 - (a) the Home Secretary, as Chairperson;
 - (b) the Secretary-General;
 - (c) one (1) Cabinet Secretary, nominated by the President;
 - (d) one (1) TAC member, nominated by the Patron;
 - (e) one (1) ordinary member, nominated by the Annual General Assembly.
- (2) The Disciplinary Sub-Committee shall hear and determine all complaints of breach of this Constitution or of the Code of Conduct, in accordance with the principles of natural justice.

31.3 Procedure

The procedure for the hearing of a disciplinary matter shall include:

- (1) the giving of written notice to the person concerned, stating the alleged breach;
- (2) the giving of an opportunity to the person concerned to be heard;
- (3) the right of the person concerned to be accompanied or represented by another member;
- (4) the leading and testing of evidence;
- (5) the issuance of a written reasoned decision.

31.4 Sanctions

Sanctions which may be imposed for breach of this Constitution or of the Code of Conduct include:

- (1) a written warning;
- (2) a reprimand;
- (3) removal from a particular office or function;
- (4) suspension of membership for a defined period;



(5) expulsion from the Movement, in accordance with Article 12.

31.5 Right of Appeal

- (1) A person dissatisfied with the decision of the Disciplinary Sub-Committee may, within thirty (30) days of receipt of the decision, appeal to the Annual General Assembly.
- (2) The decision of the Annual General Assembly on an appeal under sub-clause (1) shall be final.



PART X — AMENDMENTS, DISSOLUTION AND TRANSITIONAL

ARTICLE 32 — AMENDMENT OF THE CONSTITUTION

32.1 Power of Amendment

This Constitution may be amended in accordance with the procedure set out in this Article and not otherwise.

32.2 Initiation

(1) A proposal to amend this Constitution may be initiated by:

- (a) the Cabinet, by a resolution adopted by two-thirds majority;
- (b) the Bekwai Youth Parliament, by a resolution adopted by two-thirds majority, in respect of provisions affecting Parliament;
- (c) a petition signed by not less than fifty (50) Ordinary Members.

32.3 Notice

Notice of any proposed amendment, accompanied by the text of the proposed amendment and an explanatory note, shall be given to all members not less than forty-five (45) days before the Annual General Assembly at which the amendment is to be considered.

32.4 Adoption

- (1) An amendment to this Constitution shall be adopted by the Annual General Assembly by a two-thirds majority of Ordinary Members present and voting.
- (2) An amendment so adopted shall come into force on the date of its formal certification by the President and the Secretary-General, or such later date as the amendment may itself provide.

32.5 Entrenched Provisions

Notwithstanding the provisions of this Article, the following matters shall require not less than three-fourths (3/4) majority of Ordinary Members present and voting at the Annual General Assembly:

- (1) any amendment to the Vision and Mission set out in Article 4;
- (2) any amendment to the non-political principle in Articles 4.3 and 24.1;
- (3) any amendment to this Article 32 itself;



(4) any amendment to the dissolution provisions in Article 33.



ARTICLE 33 – DISSOLUTION OF THE MOVEMENT

33.1 Grounds for Dissolution

The Movement may be dissolved only:

- (1) where the objects of the Movement have, in the opinion of the Annual General Assembly, become incapable of fulfilment;
- (2) where the membership has, by reason of natural attrition or otherwise, become insufficient to constitute the organs required by this Constitution; or
- (3) by order of a court of competent jurisdiction.

33.2 Procedure for Dissolution

- (1) A resolution to dissolve the Movement shall be adopted only at an Annual General Assembly or a Special Annual General Assembly convened expressly for that purpose.
- (2) The resolution shall be adopted by not less than three-fourths (3/4) majority of Ordinary Members present and voting.
- (3) Notice of the proposed dissolution shall be given to the Traditional Advisory Council and to the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipal Assembly not less than ninety (90) days before the Annual General Assembly at which the resolution is to be considered.

33.3 Distribution of Assets

- (1) Upon dissolution, the assets of the Movement, after the satisfaction of all debts and liabilities, shall not be distributed to any member but shall be transferred to:
 - (a) another community-based organisation in Sefwi Bekwai with similar objects, as the Annual General Assembly shall determine; or
 - (b) the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipal Assembly, in trust for community development purposes.
- (2) The Cabinet shall, upon dissolution, prepare and publish a Final Account of the Movement, audited by an independent auditor.



ARTICLE 34 — TRANSITIONAL AND SAVING PROVISIONS

34.1 Transitional Cabinet

- (1) Pending the formal election of the Cabinet, the Founding Leadership shall constitute a Transitional Cabinet exercising all the powers of the Cabinet under this Constitution for a period not exceeding twelve (12) months from the Official Launch.
- (2) The Transitional Cabinet shall, before the expiry of the said twelve (12) months, organise the first formal Annual General Assembly at which substantive elections and appointments shall be conducted.

34.2 Phased Establishment of Communities

Where, at the date of commencement of this Constitution, all thirty-two (32) Communities have not yet appointed their representatives, the Cabinet shall, with the assistance of the Sub-Chiefs concerned, conduct phased recruitment to ensure full coverage within twelve (12) months of the Official Launch.

34.3 Saving

- (1) Any act, decision, appointment, or document made or executed by the Founding Leadership in respect of the Movement before the commencement of this Constitution shall be deemed to have been made under this Constitution and shall continue in force unless revoked or replaced.
- (2) The validity of any contract, partnership, or undertaking entered into by the Founding Leadership shall not be affected by the commencement of this Constitution.



SCHEDULES TO THE CONSTITUTION

SCHEDULE I — OATH OF SERVICE

(Article 10.3 and Article 30.2)

THE OATH OF SERVICE

I,, having been admitted as a Member [or appointed as an Officer] of the Bekwai Youth Movement, do solemnly swear (or affirm) that I will faithfully and conscientiously serve the Movement and the people of Sefwi Bekwai and the surrounding communities; that I will uphold this Constitution and the Code of Conduct; that I will perform my duties with integrity, impartiality, and to the best of my ability; that I will respect the authority of the Chiefs and the laws of the Republic of Ghana; that I will not use my position for personal advantage; and that I will, at all times, place the welfare of the community above my own interest. (So help me God / on my honour.)

Administered before the Cabinet on the day of, 20.....

Signature of Member / Officer: _____

Signature of President: _____

Signature of Secretary-General: _____



SCHEDULE II – SCHEDULE OF COMMUNITIES

(Article 8.1)

The thirty-two (32) Communities falling within the operational reach of the Movement shall comprise Sefwi Bekwai town and the thirty-one (31) surrounding sub-communities recognised by the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Council. The full list shall be maintained by the Secretary-General and shall be updated from time to time in consultation with the Traditional Advisory Council.

No.	Community Name	Sub-Chief / Traditional Authority
1	Sefwi Bekwai (Town)	Odeneho Gyapong Ababio (Paramount Chief)
2	Sub-Community No. 1 _____	_____
3	Sub-Community No. 2 _____	_____
4	Sub-Community No. 3 _____	_____
5	Sub-Community No. 4 _____	_____
6	Sub-Community No. 5 _____	_____
7	Sub-Community No. 6 _____	_____
8	Sub-Community No. 7 _____	_____
9	Sub-Community No. 8 _____	_____
10	Sub-Community No. 9 _____	_____
11	Sub-Community No. 10 _____	_____
12	Sub-Community No. 11 _____	_____
13	Sub-Community No. 12 _____	_____
14	Sub-Community No. 13 _____	_____
15	Sub-Community No. 14 _____	_____
16	Sub-Community No. 15 _____	_____
17	Sub-Community No. 16 _____	_____
18	Sub-Community No. 17 _____	_____
19	Sub-Community No. 18 _____	_____
20	Sub-Community No. 19 _____	_____
21	Sub-Community No. 20 _____	_____
22	Sub-Community No. 21 _____	_____



No.	Community Name	Sub-Chief / Traditional Authority
23	Sub-Community No. 22 _____	_____
24	Sub-Community No. 23 _____	_____
25	Sub-Community No. 24 _____	_____
26	Sub-Community No. 25 _____	_____
27	Sub-Community No. 26 _____	_____
28	Sub-Community No. 27 _____	_____
29	Sub-Community No. 28 _____	_____
30	Sub-Community No. 29 _____	_____
31	Sub-Community No. 30 _____	_____
32	Sub-Community No. 31 _____	_____

Note: This Schedule shall be completed in full at the Founding Convention through formal consultation with the Sefwi Bekwai Traditional Council. Any subsequent variation requires amendment under Article 32.

**SCHEDULE III — CABINET OFFICES***(Article 15.20)*

N o.	Office	Age Range	Term	SDG Focus
1	President of the Youth General Assembly	22–35	2 yrs × 2	SDG 16, 17
2	First Vice President	20–33	2 yrs × 2	SDG 16
3	Second Vice President	20–33	2 yrs × 2	SDG 17
4	Secretary-General	20–35	2 yrs (no limit)	SDG 16
5	Deputy Secretary-General	18–33	2 yrs × 3	SDG 17
6	Treasurer	20–40	2 yrs × 2	SDG 17
7	Deputy Treasurer	18–35	2 yrs × 3	SDG 17
8	Secretary for Education and Youth	20–38	2 yrs × 3	SDG 4, 8
9	Secretary for Health and Welfare	22–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 3, 5
10	Secretary for Economic Affairs	22–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 1, 8, 10
11	Secretary for Environment	18–38	2 yrs × 3	SDG 6, 11, 13, 15
12	Secretary for Communications	18–35	2 yrs × 3	SDG 17
13	Home Secretary	22–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 16
14	Secretary for Foreign Affairs	22–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 17
15	Secretary for Women and Equalities	18–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 5, 10
16	Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs	20–38	2 yrs × 3	SDG 16
17	Organiser (Chief Whip)	20–35	2 yrs × 3	SDG 11, 17
18	Deputy Organiser	18–33	2 yrs × 3	SDG 17



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N o.	Office	Age Range	Term	SDG Focus
1 9	Nasara / Inter-Community Liaison	20–40	2 yrs × 3	SDG 10, 16



SCHEDULE IV — CODE OF CONDUCT

(Article 31.1)

Every member, officer, and volunteer of the Bekwai Youth Movement shall, at all times, observe the following standards of conduct:

1. INTEGRITY

Every member shall act with honesty and uprightness in all matters of the Movement. No member shall make any false statement, conceal material fact, or engage in any form of deception in the affairs of the Movement.

2. NON-PARTISANSHIP

No member shall, in his or her official capacity within the Movement, campaign for, endorse, or oppose any political party, candidate, or partisan position. The Movement is and shall remain strictly non-political.

3. ABSENCE OF CORRUPTION

No member shall solicit, accept, or offer any bribe, inducement, or improper consideration in connection with the affairs of the Movement. No member shall use his or her position for personal financial advantage.

4. RESPECT

Every member shall treat fellow members, traditional authorities, public officials, and members of the public with courtesy, respect, and dignity. Discrimination on the grounds of gender, faith, ethnicity, age, or social status is strictly prohibited.

5. SAFEGUARDING OF MINORS

In all dealings with Members of the Bekwai Youth Parliament and other minors, the highest standards of safeguarding shall be observed. No adult member shall meet privately with a minor save in compliance with Article 21.2.

6. CONFIDENTIALITY

Members shall maintain confidentiality in respect of internal Movement matters where required, and shall observe the data protection obligations set out in Article 26.

7. TRADITIONAL AUTHORITY

Members shall respect the authority of Chiefs and the wisdom of elders, and shall comply with the protocols of engagement with the Traditional Advisory Council.

8. PROPERTY OF THE MOVEMENT



Members shall use the property and resources of the Movement only for the lawful purposes of the Movement, and shall not appropriate, damage, or misuse the same.

9. ATTENDANCE AND DILIGENCE

Members and officers shall attend all duly convened sittings of bodies of which they are members, and shall discharge their duties with diligence and due care.

10. COMPLIANCE WITH CONSTITUTION

Every member shall, at all times, abide by this Constitution, by all Standing Orders, By-Laws, and Regulations made hereunder.

Breach of any provision of this Code of Conduct shall be a ground for disciplinary action under Article 31 of this Constitution.



END OF CONSTITUTION



BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT

VOLUNTEERING FOR CHANGE

Sefwi Bekwai · Western North Region · Republic of Ghana · Est. 2026

This Constitution is the supreme governance instrument of the Bekwai Youth Movement.

First Edition · Adopted at Sefwi Bekwai · 2026

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